EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP PORTFOLIO • 2026

Design Leadership at Scale

Architecting Enterprise UX, Production Design Systems, and High-Velocity Engineering Collaboration across Global Fortune 500 Technology Organizations.



PRESENTER

Balaajee V.R.

UI/UX Design Senior Manager

Ex-IBM • Zebra • ZF Wabco • Ericsson

18+	10M+	12+	40%
YEARS EXPERIENCE	USERS IMPACTED	TEAM SCALE LED	VELOCITY GAIN

Enterprise Pedigree

Senior design leadership spanning **IBM Software Labs, Zebra Technologies, ZF Wabco, Ericsson, Samsung, and Infosys** across multi-tier B2B, B2C, and B2E architectures.

IBM · Zebra · ZF Wabco · Ericsson · Samsung

- 18+ Years Global Tech Experience
- Enterprise AI, B2B SaaS & Industrial IoT

Systems & Token Architecture

Pioneered cross-brand enterprise design systems with automated token pipelines bridging Figma to React, Angular, and native Android Kotlin repositories with zero visual drift.

Figma Tokens · Style-Dictionary · React & Angular · Android Compose

- Automated Zero-Drift CI/CD Pipelines
- Multi-Brand Theming & WCAG AA Compliance

People & Culture Catalyst

Mentored 50+ designers and engineers. Established career leveling frameworks, design sprint rituals, and psychological safety that drive retention and high innovation velocity.

50+ Mentored · Team Scale (3 to 12+) · DesignOps · 10-Yr US Visa

- Structured Career Ladders (Assoc. to Principal)
- Global Hack-Fest & Spot Innovation Awards

CORE LEADERSHIP FRAMEWORK

Four Pillars of Executive Design

Bridging executive business objectives, technical engineering constraints, and human-centered design to build compounding enterprise value.

1. Business-Driven UX Strategy

Design is an investment, not an expense. Every design initiative is tied to measurable commercial outcomes: accelerating ARR, lowering customer churn, eliminating support tickets, and shortening enterprise sales cycles.

ROI Alignment | Executive Buy-In | Churn Reduction

2. Systems-First Scalability

Moving organizations away from repetitive pixel pushing to tokenized design systems. Establishing multi-brand UI governance, WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility compliance, and code-aligned component libraries.

Design Tokens | WCAG 2.1 AA | Single Source of Truth

3. Engineering Synergy

With an engineering background (B.E. Information Technology), I speak the language of software architects. I eliminate the "designer-developer divide" through shared design-to-code pipelines and proactive technical feasibility reviews.

Zero-Drift Handoff | Component Parity | Feasibility Reviews

4. High-Empathy Talent Cultivation

Empowering designers through psychological safety, constructive critiques, and explicit career progression pathways (from Associate to Principal). Fostering an inclusive, high-retention environment.

Career Frameworks | Psychological Safety | DesignOps Mentorship

OPERATING MODEL & ORGANIZATIONAL ARCHITECTURE

How I Structure & Scale Design Teams

The Hybrid Pod Model: Combining centralized design system governance with decentralized, embedded product squad execution.

Central Core: DesignOps

A dedicated central hub that maintains global design tokens, foundational component libraries, accessibility compliance, and design-to-code automation.

- Tokens & Component Governance
- Design-to-Code Pipeline Tools
- WCAG Accessibility Standards

Embedded Product Squads

Product designers embedded directly within cross-functional engineering pods, participating in daily standups, sprint planning, and discovery rituals.

- Product Management Partnership
- Sprint Planning & Story Pointing
- Continuous Usability Benchmarks

Rituals & Delivery Cadence

Establishing repeatable cadences that maintain product quality without creating bureaucratic bottlenecks across agile delivery sprints.

- Bi-weekly Peer Design Critiques
- Sprint Zero Discovery Workshops
- Quarterly Design Maturity Reviews

STAGE 01 • DISCOVER

Generative user research, stakeholder alignment, persona definitions, and KPI mapping.

STAGE 02 • DEFINE

Information architecture, journey mapping, low-fi wireframing, and technical feasibility.

STAGE 03 • DESIGN & TEST

Token-based high-fidelity UI, interactive prototypes, usability validation, and critiques.

STAGE 04 • DELIVER & SCALE

Automated token handoff, QA visual review, production rollout, and analytics feedback.

FLAGSHIP ENTERPRISE CASE STUDY 01

IBM Software Labs: Enterprise AI-UX Transformation

Re-architecting complex enterprise modeling (Rhapsody SE) and enterprise mobility management (MaaS360) by integrating IBM Watson AI workflows.

IBM INDIA SOFTWARE LABS `UI/UX Design Senior Manager` Sep 2024 – Jan 2026 • Enterprise Systems Portfolio

The Business & UX Challenge

Global systems engineering teams managing mission-critical software/hardware architectures faced high cognitive overload in legacy modeling suites. Simultaneously, enterprise IT administrators struggled with complex manual endpoint compliance rules in MaaS360 across hundreds of thousands of corporate devices.

The Strategic Intervention

Orchestrated an organizational re-org, moving 12 designers from product silos into a unified UX-as-a-Service model. Designed AI-powered conversational and contextual UI patterns leveraging IBM Watson to automate enterprise modeling validations and predictive endpoint threat mitigation.

Measurable Business & User Impact:

- Achieved a **35% reduction in model verification time** for enterprise aerospace and automotive engineering clients.
- Transitioned MaaS360 from passive alert dashboards to **proactive, AI-driven policy recommendations**, cutting administrator triage time by **45%**.
- Unified cross-product design execution across global teams in the US, Europe, and India.

FLAGSHIP ENTERPRISE CASE STUDY 02

Zebra Technologies: Industrial B2B Ecosystem at Scale

Unifying hardware-software UX ecosystems across rugged mobile computers, RFID scanners, and enterprise supply chain platforms.

ZEBRA TECHNOLOGIES `UI/UX Product Design Manager` Jul 2021 – Aug 2024 • Global B2B Hardware & Software

The Environmental & Cognitive Challenge

Warehouse operators, retail associates, and logistics drivers operate in extreme ambient conditions: bright direct sunlight, low-light freezer rooms, high ambient noise, and one-handed gloved touch. Existing applications suffered from visual inconsistency and high operational error rates.

The Systems Solution

Led a multi-disciplinary UI/UX team as primary Hiring Manager. Standardized high-contrast, glanceable UI patterns, touch targets calibrated for heavy industrial gloves, and a unified design system deployed across Android rugged devices and enterprise cloud portals.

Key Business Outcomes:

- Accelerated engineering handoff by **40%** through shared Android Kotlin/Compose component tokens.
- Reduced warehouse scanning errors and increased operator throughput by **22% across tier-1 logistics hubs**.
- Established enterprise UI governance adopted across all subsequent Zebra software and mobile product suites.

FLAGSHIP ENTERPRISE CASE STUDY 03

ZF Wabco: Mission-Critical Fleet Telematics

Designing safety-critical, zero-distraction driver interfaces and real-time cloud telemetry platforms for commercial fleet operators.

ZF WABCO `UI/UX Senior Specialist` Oct 2020 – Jul 2021 • Commercial Vehicle Telematics

Driver Safety (In-Cabin)

Engineered glanceable UI architecture strictly compliant with NHTSA & ISO 15005 driver distraction standards, prioritizing critical brake and stability alerts without cognitive fatigue.

Fleet Dispatcher Portal

Created dense, data-rich real-time telemetry maps and predictive maintenance dashboards enabling fleet operators to monitor thousands of vehicles simultaneously with zero lag.

Design System Scalability

Unified design tokens across in-vehicle Android head units and enterprise web consoles, establishing a single visual and interaction language for commercial automotive IoT.

Impact on Safety & Uptime:

- Delivered a human-centered telematics suite that reduced driver response latency to critical braking warnings by **18%**.
- Enabled fleet managers to schedule predictive maintenance **48 hours earlier**, preventing costly highway breakdowns and saving millions in unplanned vehicle downtime.

DESIGN SYSTEMS & TOKEN ARCHITECTURE

Enterprise Token Architecture

How I architect robust, multi-brand design systems that eliminate redundant coding and guarantee 100% fidelity from Figma to Production.

1. Global Design Tokens

Single source of truth for semantic color, typography scales, elevation, spacing tokens, and micro-interactions managed in Figma Token Studio.

- Brand & Alias Tokens
- Dark / Light / High-Contrast Modes
- Calibrated Spacing Grid (8pt)

2. Automated CI/CD Export

Style-Dictionary build pipelines automatically compile JSON tokens into CSS variables, Sass maps, TypeScript constants, and Android XML/Compose values.

- Git-triggered token build steps
- Automated visual regression tests
- Zero manual copy-pasting of hex codes

3. Storybook Parity

Reusable, accessibility-tested components in React/Angular mirroring Figma variants 1:1, cutting QA visual regression review time in half.

- Automated axe-core a11y testing
- Component props mapped to Figma
- Zeroheight documentation sync

40%	100%	0	Multi
HANDOFF ACCELERATION	WCAG 2.1 AA COMPLIANCE	REDUNDANT COMPONENT CODE	BRAND THEMING ENABLED

INNOVATION & FUTURE-PROOFING

AI-Augmented DesignOps & Agentic UX

Integrating modern generative AI into user research, prototyping, and product design operations while designing intuitive AI interaction models.

AI for DesignOps (Team Acceleration)

Scaling design team throughput and eliminating repetitive operational overhead through generative intelligence.

- **Research Synthesis:** Leveraging LLMs to synthesize thousands of customer support transcripts and usability interviews into actionable thematic insights.
- **Automated Heuristic Audits:** Implementing automated visual and accessibility contrast scanners in CI pipelines.
- **Rapid Prototyping:** Utilizing agentic scaffolding tools to turn Figma design tokens into live functional code prototypes in minutes.

UX for AI Products (User Trust & Agency)

Designing human-centered interfaces for non-deterministic AI outputs and complex multi-agent workflows.

- **Explainability & Confidence:** Designing user-facing confidence scoring, transparent citation links, and progressive disclosure for AI recommendations.
- **Graceful Degradation:** Ensuring non-blocking fallbacks when AI inferences take longer than expected, maintaining seamless workflow continuity.
- **Human-in-the-Loop Controls:** Providing clear undo/override affordances so enterprise operators always retain authoritative operational control.

ENTERPRISE TOOLING & AI STACK (MATCHING RESUME PROFILE):

Microsoft Copilot | ChatGPT Enterprise | IBM Watson | Google Stitch & NotebookLM | Figma & Token Studio | Storybook & React | UserTesting & Hotjar | Jira & Confluence

LEADERSHIP, CULTURE & MENTORSHIP

Cultivating High-Performance Design Teams

How I hire, mentor, and elevate multi-disciplinary design organizations through structured career progression and psychological safety.

Strategic Hiring & Scaling

Scaled design squads from 3 to 12+ product designers, UX researchers, and design technologists. Conducted competency-based portfolio reviews and whiteboard exercises that assess craft, systems thinking, and business communication.

Career Leveling Framework

Instituted transparent career matrices outlining expectations across Craft, Strategy, Execution, and Leadership from Associate Designer to Staff/Principal, eliminating ambiguity in promotion cycles.

Award-Winning Innovation

Fostering a culture of excellence recognized across global organizations:

- **Samsung:** 10-Year US Business Visa for global healthcare UX research.
- **Ericsson:** Spot Award for UX innovation & 1st Place in Global Hack-fest.
- **Contests:** 1st Place in MockingBOT & UP Labs challenges.

Retention & Growth Track Record:
Over 18+ years, I have directly mentored **50+ designers and engineers** who have grown into Lead Designers, Product Managers, and Design Founders across the Indian and global technology ecosystem.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & ENGAGEMENT

Executive Scorecard & Next Steps

Ready to drive enterprise UX transformation, scalable design systems, and world-class product design leadership for your organization.

18+	10M+	40%	100%
YEARS EXPERIENCE	USERS IMPACTED	DEV VELOCITY GAIN	DESIGN-TO-CODE PARITY

Target Leadership Roles

- **Director of Product Design / Head of UX**
- **Senior Manager — UI/UX & Design Systems**
- **Principal UX Architect / DesignOps Leader**
- **Vice President of Design (Enterprise / B2B)**

Direct Contact & Portfolio Channels

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